



PART 1 STARTING POINTS: Media language

The codes and conventions of media forms and products, including the processes through which media language develops as genre.

THIIIRD has a distinctive house style consistent across both print and digital magazines. The minimalist, modern layout of vibrant colours with limited text foregrounds the stories behind the striking photographic images and the branding of the title. The scrolling images are all portraits of people of colour, fashion images or shots of the print front cover. The serene purple background of the website's home page contrasts with the simple white lettering of the masthead across the top and the strapline that scrolls along the foot of the first screen – AMPLIFYING UNDERREPRESENTED VOICES – which anchors the meaning behind the selection of images. (See here:

[Thiird \(thiirdmagazine.co.uk\)](http://thiirdmagazine.co.uk)

Strong blocks of colour opposites, such as orange or fresh green against the purple, contrast to highlight the contextual information of the website. It also draws attention to its statement of values, the manifesto and the images of the editorial team, their names and roles. It is clear that all are of mixed cultural heritage or people of colour, and predominantly women. They all have @ links to their Instagram accounts, inviting us to find out more and participate in the THIIIRD community, and possibly collaborate with the project.

The masthead is classical in design, in simple, sans serif uppercase lettering. This gives the brand a sense of authority and confidence. The quirky design of the three pillars in the centre gives it a unique identity, making it instantly recognisable as a logo. The design of the III in Roman numerals connotes classical architecture, like the pillars of the Parthenon in Athens – respectable, important, the home of democracy. At the same time, they reflect the triple meaning of

the title, reinforcing the idea of the third space theory, third kid culture and the third eye. This design gives the magazine a distinct brand identity for the community of readers it is aimed towards.

THIIIRD

[Image by Thiirdmagazine.co.uk](http://thiirdmagazine.co.uk)

The wide-ranging bank of stories are neatly laid out against a white background, leading with a strong, enigmatic and colourful image and a short caption title, which positions us to be intrigued and want to find out more. For example, Swim Dem Crew shows two bearded men smiling, in orange and green swimming hats; Skater UKTIS, the group of Muslim women redefining skater culture; the Let's Let Black Boys SMILE project; an interview with Munroe Bergdorf and many more.

How the combination of elements of media language influence meaning.

The first image you see on the website is a low angled MCU shot looking up at a regal looking, young Black model wearing a 1950s vintage pillbox hat with a veil. The hat has been customised with diamante beads and a red chiffon scarf to resemble a head-dress. The cultural connotations of the image are richly multifaceted and different audiences will bring their own cultural competences to read these dress codes in different ways. Her purple eyeshadow links with the brand colour of the background of the homepage, and the red of her top and scarf link with colour blocks on the rest of the page and with the menu bar, creating a unified design. She appears to be an iconic model for THIIIRD, and her style is idiosyncratic, confident and powerful. This image is juxtaposed by a highly stylised soft-coloured image of two women with ornately braided hair, their heart shaped embrace and gaze towards the viewer draw you in to another intriguing narrative.